



IF YOU'RE LOST: S.T.O.P.

S -- SIT DOWN

Stop moving immediately. Every step in the wrong direction takes you farther from rescuers.

T -- THINK

When did you last know your location? Can you retrace your steps safely?

O -- OBSERVE

Look for landmarks, trail markers, listen for roads/water. Check your map.

P -- PLAN

If unsure, STAY PUT. Make yourself visible. Signal for help. We search your planned route first.

#1 RULE

STAY PUT. 80% of lost hikers are found within 1 mile of their last known position -- when they don't wander.

BEFORE YOU GO: FREE SATELLITE 911 TEXTING

T-Mobile offers FREE satellite 911 texting for ALL carriers (AT&T, Verizon, etc.) via Starlink. Works on 60+ phone models (iPhone 13+, Galaxy S21+, Pixel 9+). No subscription for emergency use.

SIGNALING METHODS

❑ **WHISTLE (best):** 3 short blasts, pause, repeat. Heard up to 1 mile. Uses no energy.

❑ **MIRROR:** Flash toward aircraft/ridgelines. Visible up to 10 miles on clear day.

❑ **FIRE:** Visible at night. Add green branches for white smoke during day.

❑ **BRIGHT COLORS:** Spread gear in open area. Wave bright items when you hear searchers.

❑ **GROUND SIGNALS:** X = need medical help. V = need assistance. Make 10ft+ tall.

❑ **3 OF ANYTHING:** 3 fires, 3 blasts, 3 flashes = universal distress signal.

YOUR VOICE

Shout 'HELP' in groups of 3. A whistle is 10x more effective -- always carry one.

ELECTRONIC SIGNALS

❑ **CELL PHONE:** Try 911 even with no bars -- connects via any carrier. Text 911 if you can't call.

❑ **SATELLITE 911:** FREE for all carriers via T-Mobile/Starlink. Sign up before you travel.

❑ t-mobile.com/satellite-911

❑ **IPHONE SOS:** iPhone 14+ has built-in satellite SOS. Practice: Settings > Emergency SOS > Test.

❑ **ANDROID SOS:** Pixel 9+, Galaxy S25+ support satellite emergency messaging.

❑ **GARMIN INREACH:** Two-way satellite messaging. SOS with 24/7 monitoring.

BATTERY CRITICAL?

Airplane mode between 911 attempts. Reduce brightness. Text uses less power than calls.



Sign Up Free

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